recovered land – which to this day is referred to by some as Parashurama Kshetra, ‘the land of Parashurama’, stretching from Gokarna in Karnataka to the southern tip of Kerala – was gifted by Parashurama to the Brahmins, whom he brought down from the North to settle the land. Since Parashurama had killed off all the Kshatriyas, the Brahmins were left in sole control of the local population, whom they classed either as Shudras or those without caste.



The axe-wielding Parashurama, who recovered the Malabar coast for the Brahmins. Detail of a miniature from an album of drawings owned by Thomas Baber, Collector and Judge in the Malabar Province of the Madras Presidency from 1798 to 1838. He returned to England but then sailed back to India to settle in Tellicherry, where he died in 1843.